

“I BELIEVE THAT ONLY A STRONG COMMITMENT ON THE PART OF THE PEOPLE CAN SAVE MOTHER EARTH.”

Chandi Prasad Bhatt was born in the mountainous region of present-day Uttarakhand. Deeply influenced by Gandhi’s call to serve, he dedicated himself from a young age to working for the welfare of people in his home district, Mandal. In 1973, Bhatt mobilized villagers in Mandal to resist the commercial felling of trees through non-violent methods. This was where the first instance of ‘chipko’ occurred, when Bhatt suggested that the villagers hug the trees to protect them. The protest was a success, and sparked a movement that spread across the region and remains an inspiration to environmentalists everywhere.